

Godagama 10200 Urbanization Evidence Report

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Date: 2026-06-27

Study focus: Godagama town, 1 km core, 3 km local catchment, 5 km pressure zone, and comparator towns Homagama, Meegoda, Kottawa/Makumbura, Kahathuduwa, and Padukka.

Executive findings

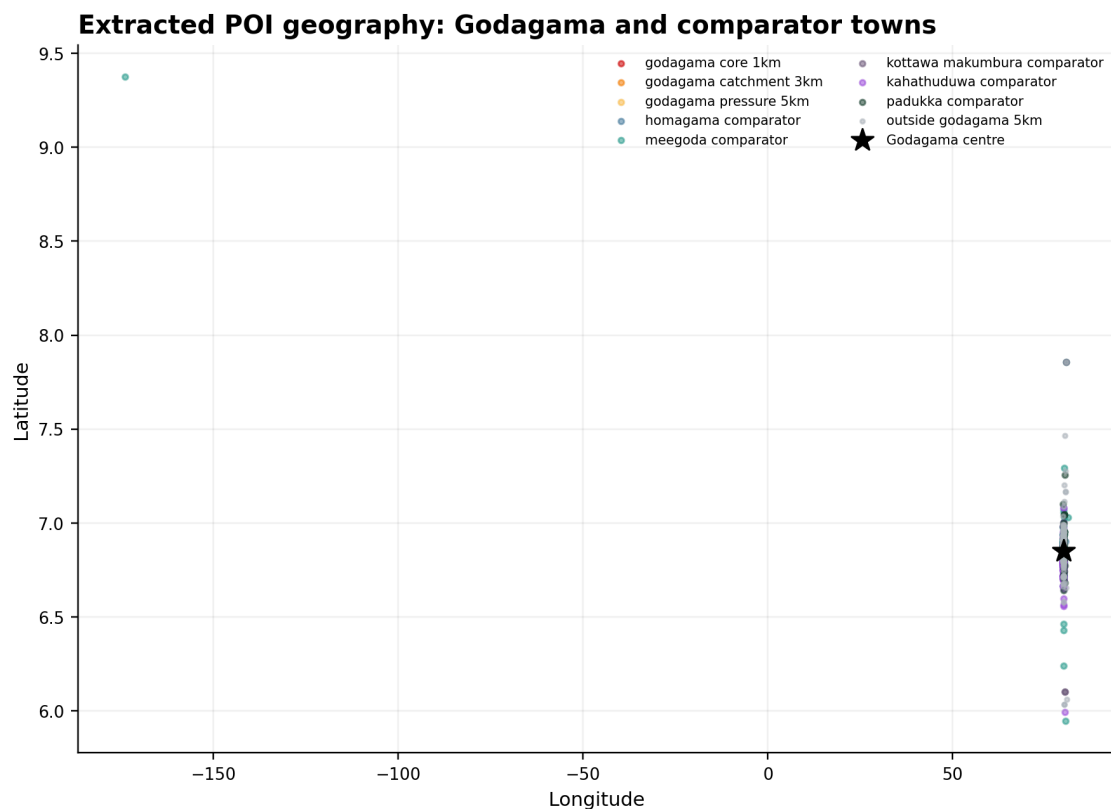
1. **Godagama is already a concentrated town core.** The Google-derived POI extract contains **274 POIs in the 1 km core**, equal to **87.2 POIs/km²** in the extracted sample. The wider **3 km Godagama catchment has 440 POIs** or **15.6 POIs/km²**.
2. **Godagama's current commercial layer is younger than most comparator towns in this dataset.** **82.4%** of dated Godagama 3 km POIs have earliest visible activity from **2021 onward**. That is higher than Homagama, Meegoda, Kottawa/Makumbura, and Kahathuduwa in this extract.
3. **Property/developer pressure is already comparable to larger nodes.** In the Godagama 3 km catchment, **63 of 440 POIs (14.3%)** are apartments, land developments, or real-estate offices. That share is similar to Homagama and Kottawa/Makumbura, even though Godagama's total POI density is lower.
4. **OpenStreetMap history shows the physical network expanding before the commercial layer fully matures.** From 2018 to 2026 in the Godagama-area bounding box, mapped buildings rose from **922 to 4036 (+338%)**, while mapped road length rose from **280.7 km to 374.5 km (+33%)**. Mapped shops rose from **30 to 45**, and mapped food/drink places rose from **9 to 17**.
5. **The measured pressure ranking puts Godagama below Kahathuduwa, Meegoda, and Kottawa/Makumbura, but its town core is already intense.** The report's 0–100 pressure score uses only observed variables: current POI density, post-2020 activity share, property/developer density, and chain/finance anchor density. Godagama's 3 km score is **34.5**. Separately, the UDA plan also identifies Godagama and Kahathuduwa as commercial intensification zones.

Data used

Dataset	Rows / scope	What it measures	Main limitation
Google Maps-derived POI extract	3,495 POIs	Current commercial/social/institutional places and earliest visible photo/activity date	Earliest photo date is an activity proxy, not a confirmed opening date; review count and first review date are not decoded yet
Google POI geodata	3,495 points	Spatial distribution by town/comparator	Search result caps and broad queries can pull corridor results
OSM/ohsome baseline	7 time slices, 2014–2026	Buildings, roads, shops, food/drink, amenities	OSM edit history is affected by mapping completeness
UDA/RDA/planning sources	Homagama plan, expressway/gazette data, developer pages	Zoning, interchange access, environmental controls, developer market signals	Planning facts need map-layer digitization for parcel-level use

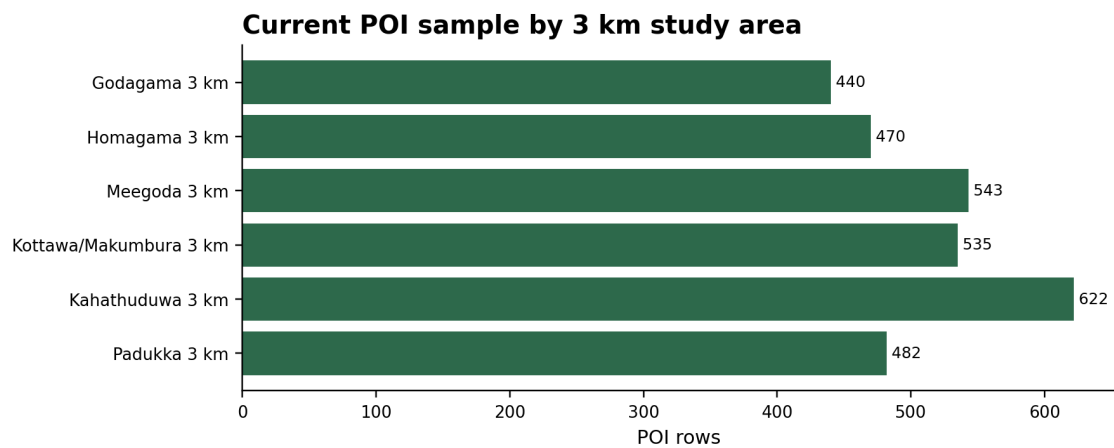
Coverage in the Google-derived POI extract:

- **3,385 / 3,495 POIs** have earliest visible activity/photo dates.
- **2,744 / 3,495 POIs** have ratings.
- **2,459 / 3,495 POIs** have phone numbers.
- **968 / 3,495 POIs** have websites.

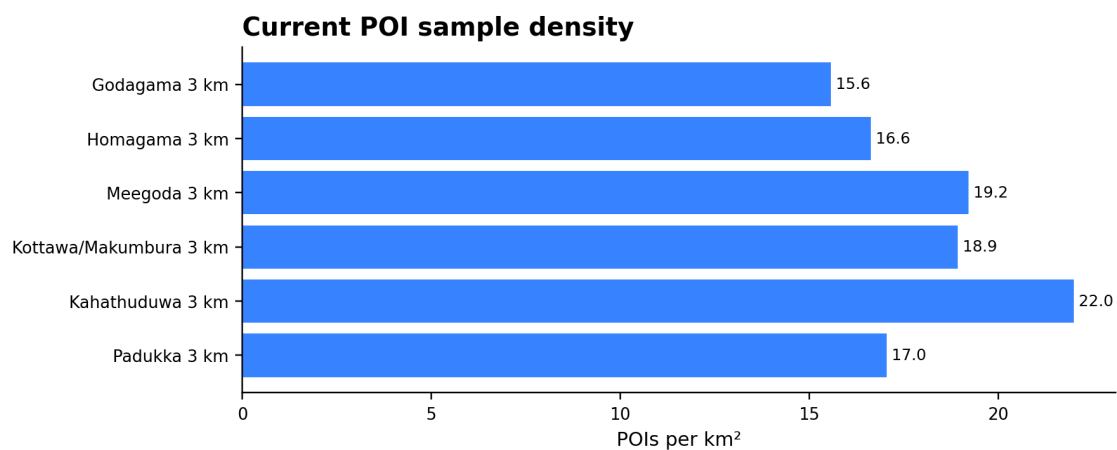


Extracted POI geography

Current urban structure

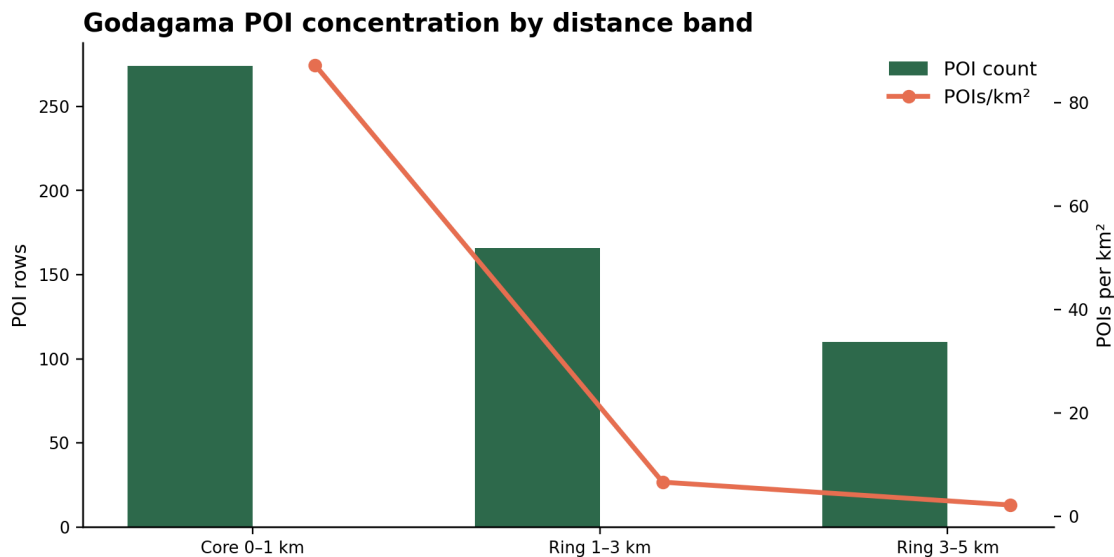


Current POI sample by area



Current POI density

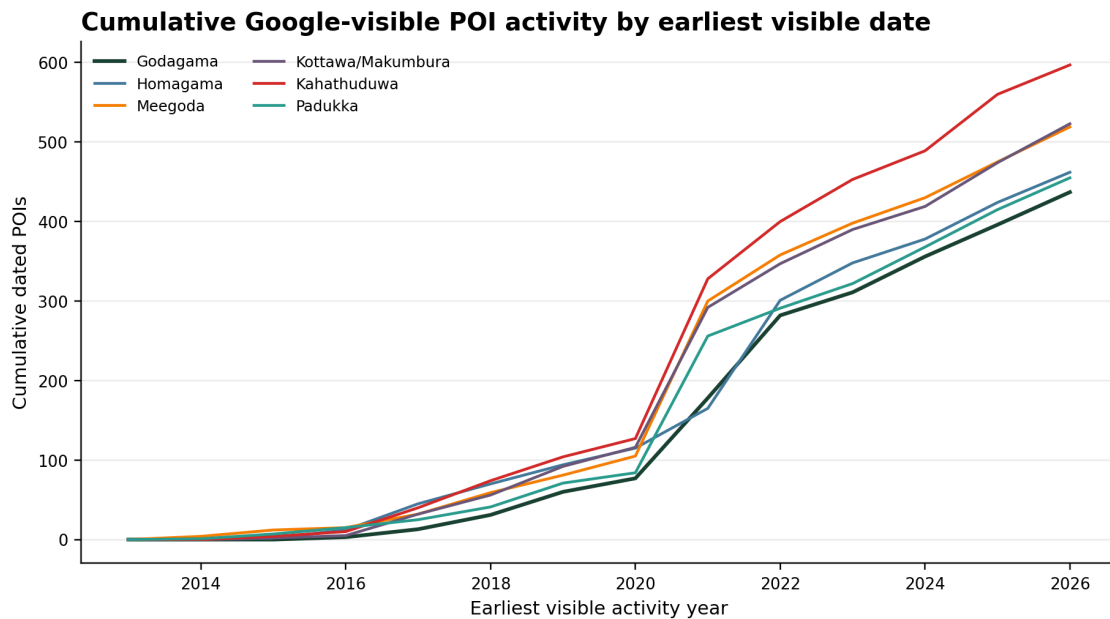
Godagama's 3 km catchment has less total POI density than Kahathuduwa, Meegoda, Kottawa/Makumbura, and Padukka in this extract. The difference changes inside the 1 km town core: the core is dense, while the outer rings are thinner.



Godagama distance-band structure

Timeline signal: earliest visible Google activity

This chart counts each current POI by the earliest visible activity date decoded from photo metadata. It is not a verified opening-date chart. It is useful as a comparable visibility/activity signal because the same extraction method is applied across all study areas.

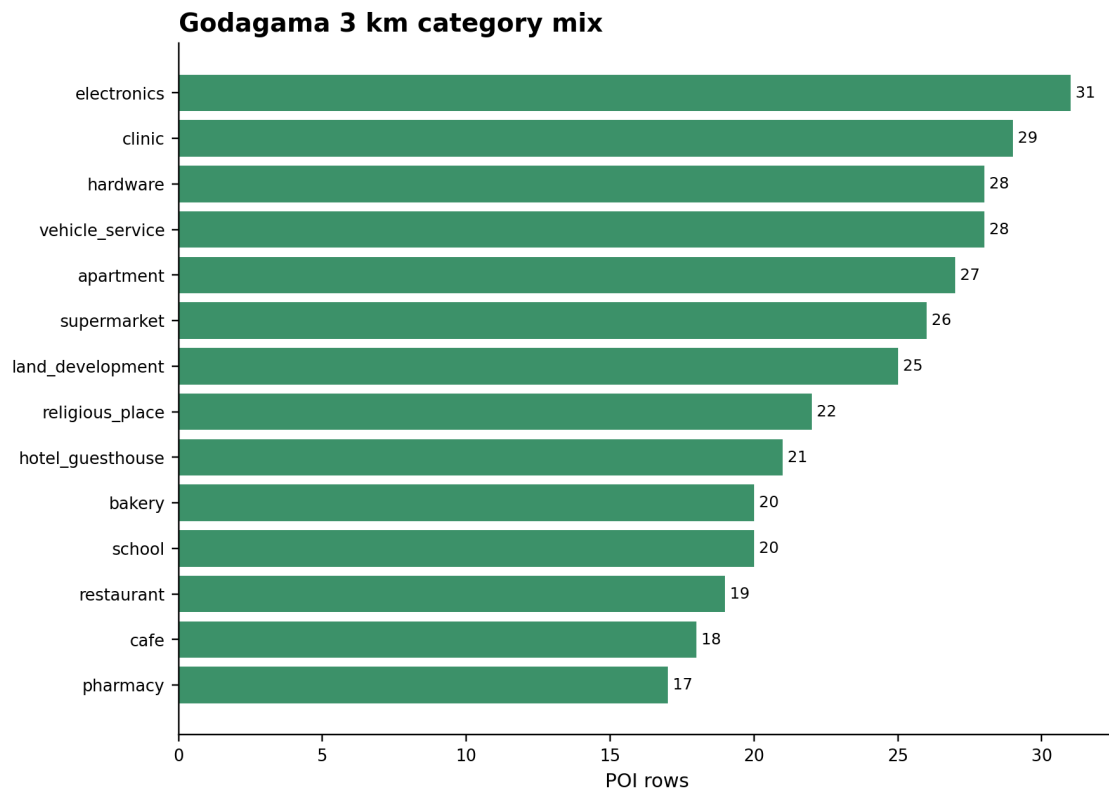


Cumulative first-visible timeline

Key table:

Area	POIs	POIs/km ²	First visible 2021+	Property share	Property POIs	Local productive POIs	Pressure score
Godagama 3 km	440	15.6	82.4%	14.3%	63	111	34.5
Homagama 3 km	470	16.6	75.1%	14.0%	66	137	21.0
Meegoda 3 km	543	19.2	79.8%	11.2%	61	118	58.0
Kottawa/Makumbura 3 km	535	18.9	77.8%	14.2%	76	135	53.6
Kahathuduwa 3 km	622	22.0	78.7%	10.5%	65	136	72.2
Padukka 3 km	482	17.0	81.5%	11.4%	55	138	31.2

Godagama category mix



Godagama category mix

The 3 km Godagama catchment is not only food/retail. Its largest visible categories include electronics, clinics, hardware, vehicle service, apartments, supermarkets, and land development. That mix indicates a practical service town with rising property pressure, not a pure restaurant/café suburb.

Grouped Godagama 3 km counts:

Group	Count	Share of Godagama 3 km POIs
property/developer	63	14.3%
essential services	165	37.5%
local productive services	111	25.2%
food/social	63	14.3%

Commercial and chain anchors in the Godagama 5 km pressure zone

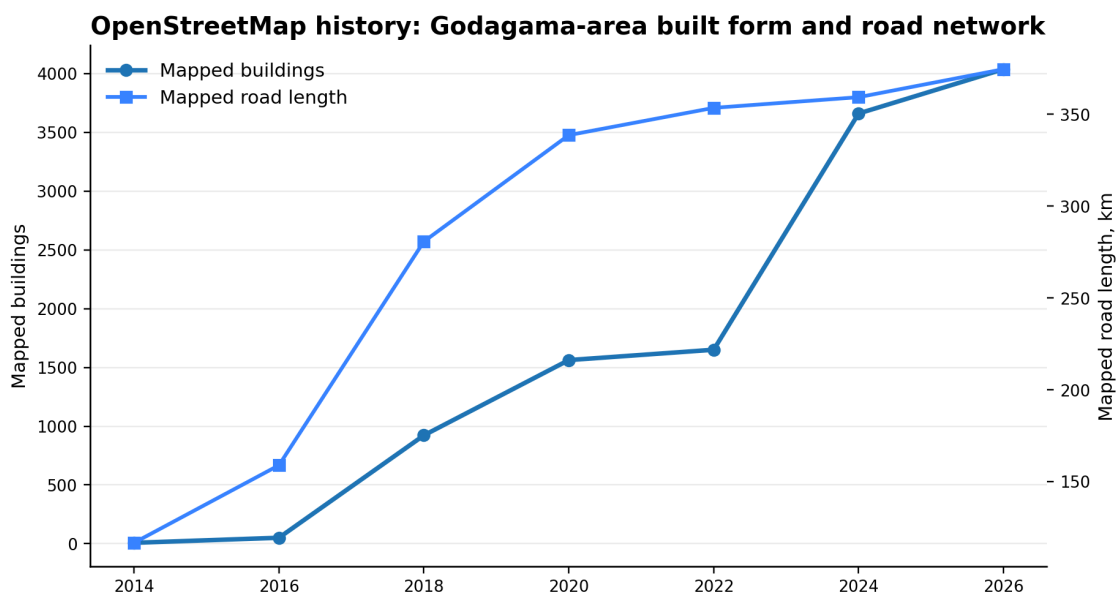
This table uses name/address matching, not the extractor's query-assigned brand field.

Anchor	Matched POIs in 5 km	Earliest visible date in extract	Examples
Cargills	12	2018-02-27	Cargills Food City - Godagama; Cargills Food City Express -

Anchor	Matched POIs in 5 km	Earliest visible date in extract	Examples
			Habarakada; Cargills Food City - Homagama 1
Sathosa	6	2017-11-06	Sathosa Godagama සතොස; Lanka Sathosa; Lanka Sathosa-Meegoda
BOC	5	2015-11-06	Bank of Ceylon; Bank of Ceylon; boc Atm Meegoda
P&S / Perera and Sons	4	2020-02-22	P&S (Perera & Sons) - Godagama; P&S (Perera and Sons) - Homagama; P&S (Perera & Sons) - Homagama Katuwana Road
Commercial Bank	3	2019-06-22	Commercial Bank ATM & CDM; Commercial Bank; Commercial Bank ATM
Home Lands	3	2021-04-08	Home Lands Main Store - Mullegama; Premadasa Home land; Home Land Housing Scheme
LOLC	3	2017-05-20	LOLC Finance PLC Homagama; LOLC Development Finance; LOLC Advanced Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
HNB	2	2018-12-15	HNB Homagama (Hatton National Bank); Hatton National Bank ATM
Keells	2	2019-11-16	Keells - Godagama; Keells - Godagama Male Boarding
People's Bank	2	2016-03-31	People's Bank; People's Bank
Prime Lands	2	2019-08-11	Blinto By Prime Lands; Green Valley(Prime Land)
Sampath Bank	2	2017-08-15	Sampath Bank Homagama; Sampath Bank Touchless ATM
Pizza Hut	1	2025-04-12	Pizza Hut - Godagama

Interpretation from the table: Godagama already has formal supermarket, bakery/food, banking/finance, and land-development anchors inside the 5 km pressure zone. The anchor count is lower than larger comparator nodes, but the categories are already present.

OSM built-form baseline



OSM buildings and roads growth

OpenStreetMap history gives a separate physical-growth signal. The 2018–2026 change is large enough that the direction is clear even after allowing for mapping-completeness bias:

OSM metric	2018	2026	Change
Mapped buildings	922	4036	+338%
Mapped road length	280.7 km	374.5 km	+33%
Mapped shops	30	45	+50%
Mapped food/drink places	9	17	+89%

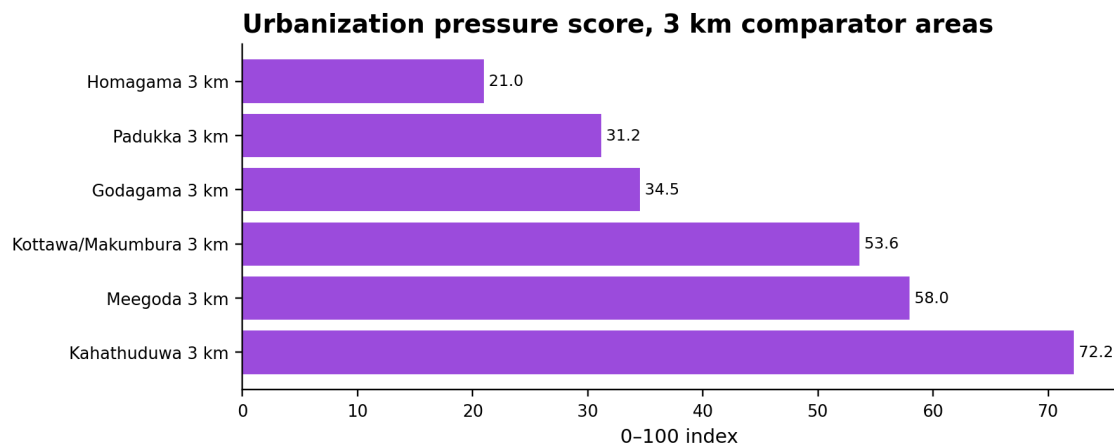
Urbanization pressure model

The model is a triage score for where to do fieldwork and planning review first. It is not a land-price forecast.

Score inputs for each 3 km area:

- 35% current POI density per km²;
- 25% share of dated POIs first visible from 2021 onward;
- 25% property/developer density per km², using apartment + land development + real-estate office categories;
- 15% chain/finance anchor density per km², using name/address matching.

Each input is min-max normalized across the six 3 km comparator areas, then weighted into a 0–100 score.



Urbanization pressure score

Readout:

- **Kahathuduwa** has the strongest measured pressure profile in this model. It also has a separate official planning signal: High-Density Commercial Zone II and interchange-led guide-plan logic.
- **Meegoda** has high POI density and strong chain/finance anchor density. Its economic-centre/agri-logistics role is already clearer than Godagama's.
- **Kottawa/Makumbura** has the strongest property/developer density in the sample, consistent with highway/multimodal access pressure.
- **Godagama** is a lower-density 3 km catchment but has a dense 1 km core, a high post-2020 activity share, and property/developer share similar to larger nodes. The measured pattern is: urbanized core, thinner outer catchment, rising property signal.

Planning and policy facts to include in any stakeholder discussion

Planning / transport fact	Data point	Use in model
UDA zoning	Godagama is High-Density Commercial Zone III; Kahathuduwa is High-Density Commercial Zone II	Treat both as officially enabled growth nodes; compare Godagama against the higher-intensity Kahathuduwa interchange zone.
Expressway access	Kottawa interchange is about 3 km from Homagama town; Kahathuduwa interchange is inside Homagama PS	Model growth as High Level Road + interchange-access pressure, not only central Colombo spillover.
Environmental controls	Wetland Nature Conservation Zone and Paddy/Wetland Agricultural Zone are explicit control layers; larger/sensitive commercial projects trigger CEA/UDA review	Use protect/guide/intensify zones instead of blanket development.
Developer evidence	Prime Lands and Home Lands pages market Homagama/Godagama/Kahathuduwa/Mirigama projects with highway/interchange access and future-value claims	Use land-development POIs and project pages as market-response proxies.

Data-driven planning suggestions

These are derived from the observed pattern: dense core, younger activity layer, property pressure, and official commercial zoning.

1. Treat the 1 km core as a town-centre management zone

Observed basis: **274 POIs in 1 km** and **87.2 POIs/km²**.

Use this zone for frontage rules, pedestrian crossings, parking management, drainage upgrades, shade trees, loading/unloading control, and protection of small shopfronts.

2. Treat the 1–3 km ring as the local-business expansion zone

Observed basis: Godagama 3 km has **111 local productive-service POIs** and **63 property/developer POIs**.

Use this ring to keep space for hardware, vehicle service, electronics, courier, repair, clinics, food, bakeries, and plant/garden businesses instead of allowing only gated residential subdivisions.

3. Treat the 3–5 km ring as a guide-and-protect zone

Observed basis: the 5 km zone adds property and chain anchors, while the UDA plan contains wetland/paddy conservation controls.

Use this zone for drainage-path protection, paddy/wetland screening, road connectivity review, and developer contribution requirements before approvals.

4. Benchmark Godagama against Kahathuduwa and Kottawa, not only Homagama

Observed basis: Kahathuduwa and Kottawa/Makumbura show higher pressure scores and stronger interchange logic. Their current pattern is a useful benchmark for Godagama's next stage.

Use comparator monitoring: repeat this POI extraction quarterly and track whether Godagama's 3 km score moves toward Kahathuduwa/Kottawa levels.

5. Build the local identity around observed strengths

Observed basis: Godagama 3 km has meaningful counts in clinics, hardware, vehicle service, electronics, supermarkets, apartments, and land development. It is not yet dominated by one signature sector.

The data supports positioning Godagama as a practical local-enterprise town: services, repairs, food, daily retail, garden/plant/agri links, and responsible town-centre growth.

Next data collection pass

For a stronger second report, collect these missing fields for the highest-value 200 POIs:

1. review count;
2. first review date;
3. full photo timeline, not only earliest decoded photo date;
4. official opening date from chain pages / Facebook / Wayback;
5. Street View or Earth presence/absence for selected buildings and land projects;
6. land price per perch and project block counts for land-development POIs;
7. UDA zoning polygons and wetland/paddy layers as GIS files.

Sources and files

Data files:

- `urbanization/data/google_maps_godagama_pois.csv`
- `urbanization/data/google_maps_godagama_pois.geojson`
- `urbanization/data/godagama-osm-ohsome-baseline-2026-06-26.csv`
- `urbanization/data/godagama_urbanization_model_stats_2026-06-27.json`
- `urbanization/data/godagama_urbanization_region_stats_2026-06-27.csv`

Generated map/report files:

- `urbanization/reports/google_maps_godagama_pois_map.html`
- `urbanization/reports/godagama-urbanization-data-report-2026-06-27.md`
- `urbanization/reports/godagama-urbanization-data-report-2026-06-27.html`
- `urbanization/reports/godagama-urbanization-data-report-2026-06-27.pdf`

Source documents:

- Homagama Development Plan 2021–2030 / UDA:
`https://www.uda.gov.lk/attachments/dev-plans-2021-2030/homagama\_dev\_plan\_eng.pdf`
- RDA expressway operations/history: `https://www.exway.rda.gov.lk/exway/index.php?page=about`
- RDA active interchanges: `https://www.exway.rda.gov.lk/exway/index.php?page=posts/post\_a00001`
- RDA/gazette archive: `https://www.exway.rda.gov.lk/exway/index.php?page=downloads`
- DCS Census Data Portal:
`https://www.statistics.gov.lk/DashBoard/censusdataportal`
- Prime Lands examples: Dagny Godagama, Landify Homagama, Ever Green Kahathuduwa, Novara Kadawatha
- Home Lands inventory/API evidence: `https://api.homelands.lk/api/land`
- ohsome / OpenStreetMap history source: `https://api.ohsome.org/`